



8-10-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZpCm4LKGcxl
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 10, 2021

Report Publication Date: October 24, 2023

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees was called to order at 5:00 PM by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Olive, and Mr. Lowe (Board Member / Facilities Lead). (Note: Board members Mrs. Bales and Mrs. Barnes Griffin were recorded via roll call response or presence indicators during opening procedures).
 - **Absent:** Dr. Kwiatkowski (traveling).
 - **Designee:** Dr. Reynolds presented the CEO report in Dr. Kwiatkowski's absence.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Prior Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard procedural progression).*
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:08:00 Consent Agenda (Items A through F)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / District Principals / Human Resources (Dylan).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board recognized several long-serving staff members retiring or moving on from Muncie schools after 10+ years of service (including Cammy Abreal, Taryn Fine, Brian Hirons, Melody Matson Backer, and Rachel Miller). Staff also reported strong opening-day enrollment and noted that the district was down to a need for only three remaining teaching positions (a 5th-grade teacher at South View, an SLP position, and an art teacher).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:11:12 Item 35: Permission to Advertise the 2022 Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Chief Financial Officer / Business Manager).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Brad presented the annual 18-month budget advertisement process across the district's three primary funds (Education Fund, Operation Fund, and Debt Service Fund). Key highlights included:
 - **Education Fund:** Proposed at \$34.1 million (up slightly from \$32.2 million), largely driven by state basic grants and student enrollment formulas. Approximately 76% goes toward wages and benefits.
 - **Operation Fund:** Proposed at \$12.6 million (down slightly from \$12.7 million), heavily impacted by local tax caps (\$9.8 million estimated tax cap loss for 2022). It includes approximately \$1.9 million for utilities.
 - **Debt Service Fund:** Proposed at a little over \$5.1 million for normal debt service payments, plus a temporary borrowing line item to comply with recent rule changes.
 - Total advertised spending budget: \$51.8 million with a balanced budget projection and a projected cash surplus of approximately \$1 million.
 - The schedule locks in a public hearing for August 24, 2021, and budget adoption for September 14, 2021.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion by Jim Lowe, Second by Mr. Irvin).

00:48:16 Permission to Advertise for Construction Manager (Constructor)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome / Jim Lowe.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration requested permission to advertise for a "Construction Manager as Constructor" (CMc) to oversee upcoming major capital projects at EWA and South View Elementary, funded via federal COVID-19 relief (ESSER) funds. The estimated projects total roughly \$24 million (\$8 million for EWA, \$7 million for South View). Using a CMc allows the district to bring in a contractor upfront during design phases to manage phasing, cost control, and minimize student/staff disruption. Bids will be taken August 18, with final award expected at the September 14 board meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or distinct citizen speakers addressed the board during this session.*
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **First Day of School:** Board members and administration celebrated a highly successful, smooth first day of school with high student turnout and positive parent feedback regarding safety protocols.
 - **State Fair Band Champions:** The board celebrated the "Spirit of Muncie" marching band and guard for winning the Indiana State Fair band day championship (their first state title since the 2014 consolidation/merger). Plans are underway for a formal board recognition meeting (potentially moved to the central auditorium) and a community celebration at the football stadium.
 - **Olympic Recognition:** A brief mention was made honoring former Muncie Central coach Mike Drewes, whose daughter played on the U.S. Olympic gold-medal volleyball team.
 - **Innovation Plan Review:** Board leadership noted plans to schedule a training session with senior staff to review the upcoming innovation plan report due to the legislature in late October.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second.
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